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Graduate Recruitment Team

DC Advisory

5 King William Street

London EC4N 7DA

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the 2027 Graduate Analyst Programme in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. DC Advisory's role advising OMERS Private Equity on the sale of Network Plus to Warburg Pincus in June 2026 shows the kind of UK infrastructure work I would most like to learn.

My clearest preparation for banking has been taking transactions apart. As co-founder and Treasurer of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, the university's first agri-finance society, I grew membership to 126 and led weekly research sessions on deals such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, explaining the strategic rationale, the deal structure and the valuation to members, including many from outside finance. My strongest academic results are in the same territory: 90% in first-year Finance and 78%, the second-highest mark, in a third-year group project for Advanced Corporate Finance and Financial Markets.

Investment banking appeals to me because every transaction is a chain of judgements about who should buy, why now and at what price, and each one has to survive scrutiny from clients and counterparties. The analyst's part in that chain is accuracy under deadline, a habit I have built outside the classroom. For nearly two years at KONG, I reconciled end-of-shift cash and card takings while studying full-time. I now run the drinks programme as Head Mixologist at Le Set, a new 200-cover Glasgow venue, where I wrote the batch specifications and trained around 15 bar staff to standards that have to hold when someone else executes them.

DC Advisory stands out to me because it pairs a mid-market focus, where analysts see deals from origination to completion, with real depth in infrastructure and energy; in June 2026 it advised OMERS Private Equity on the sale of Network Plus, which helps maintain and improve the UK's critical infrastructure, to Warburg Pincus. My dissertation on European gas markets has given me a working understanding of how energy and utility businesses earn and risk their returns, and a programme that recruits only eight to ten graduates a year would let me contribute to live deals early.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan